among the upper classes, were preserved and new ones were added to them. Not only the national economy but thought itself became stationary, traditional, rigid, unexpansive and unprogressive.

The conception and practice of caste embodied the aristo-

** Quoted by G. T. Garratt in 'The Ltgacy of India' (1937), p. xi.*

cratic ideal and was obviously opposed to democratic concep-

t i o n s . **It** had its strong sense of *noblesse oblige*, provided people [kept to their hereditary stations and did not challenge the estab-lished order. India's success and achievements were on the whole [confined to the upper classes; those lower down in the scale had [very few chances and their opportunities were stricdy limited.

I These upper classes were not small limited groups but large in numbers and there was a diffusion of power, authority and in-fluence. Hence they carried on successfully for a very long period. But the ultimate weakness and failing of the caste system and the Indian social structure were that they degraded a mass of human beings and gave them no opportunities to get out of that condi-tion—educationally, culturally, or economically. That degrada-

I tion brought deterioration, all along the line including in its scope